RESEARCH ASSISTANT REPORT

What the tourism and hospitality industry talks about

Themes, trends and brands in nine industry websites, 10 October 2016 – 10 October 2026

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9,060	8	11	19	93
articles analysed	websites	years (2016–2026)	themes coded	brand families found

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Summary

This report analyses 9,060 English-language articles published between 10 October 2016 and 10 October 2026 by 8 of the nine tourism and hospitality organisations and trade publishers named in the brief. It answers four questions: which themes dominate the current industry discussion and in what tone; how the leading themes changed year by year; what each website's community focuses on; and which brands are discussed and what they are associated with. Section 2 explains how the data were collected and analysed.

- **Current discussion.** In the twelve months to 10 October 2026, the most discussed themes were **Travel demand & economic performance** (23% of articles), **Sustainability & climate** (21%) and **Safety, security & crisis resilience** (20%). Artificial intelligence ranks 12th when every website counts equally, but it is the fastest-growing theme: from at most 0.8% of articles in any year before 2023 to 7% in 2026, concentrated in the trade media.
- **Tone.** Industry websites rarely write negatively: for 18 of the 19 themes fewer than 10% of articles are negative, and most of the rest is neutral, factual reporting. Positive tone is strongest for Culture, heritage & gastronomy, Inclusion, community & accessibility and Sustainability & climate and weakest for the themes about threats — Costs, inflation & affordability, COVID-19 pandemic and Policy, regulation & visas.
- **Change over time.** Workforce, skills & education led the discussion before the pandemic; COVID-19 was the leading theme in 2020–2022 (peaking at 58% of articles in 2020); since 2023 Sustainability & climate has led most years. The largest gains between 2017–19 and 2023–25 are in Sustainability & climate, Travel demand & economic performance, Investment & hotel development and Costs, inflation & affordability.
- **Each website has its own agenda.** UN Tourism: Sustainability & climate. WTTC: Travel demand & economic performance. PATA: Air, cruise & connectivity. AHLA: Workforce, skills & education. ETC: Travel demand & economic performance. CTO: COVID-19 pandemic. Hospitality Net: Guest experience & wellness. Travel Weekly: Air, cruise & connectivity.

- **Brands.** Of the ten brands in the Global Brands Magazine 2026 list, Marriott International, Hilton and IHG Hotels & Resorts are discussed most often. The hotel groups are discussed mainly in connection with Guest experience & wellness, Investment & hotel development and Workforce, skills & education; the online platforms with Distribution, OTAs & loyalty, Artificial intelligence and Policy, regulation & visas.

2. Data and methodology

2.1 Sources and scope

The study covers the nine websites named in the brief: three intergovernmental or regional tourism bodies (UN Tourism, the European Travel Commission and the Caribbean Tourism Organization), four industry associations (WTTC, IH&RA, PATA and AHLA) and two trade-media publishers (Hospitality Net and Travel Weekly). The brief mentions ten websites but lists nine; the Global Brands Magazine page is used as the reference list of brands rather than as a tenth source. The study period runs from 10 October 2016 to 10 October 2026 (ten years), restricted to English-language news articles, press releases and blog posts. Reports, report landing pages, event listings, directories and membership pages were excluded from the analysis. “Current” refers to the last twelve months of the period: 11 October 2025 to 10 October 2026.

Table 1. The nine websites and the articles analysed from each.

Website	Type	Articles analysed	Of which current	Years	% from web archive
UN Tourism	Intergovernmental body	1305	41	2016–2026	0.0
WTTC	Industry association	733	99	2016–2026	10.6
IH&RA	Industry association	0	0	–	0.0
PATA	Industry association	2344	307	2016–2026	26.2
AHLA	Industry association	535	60	2016–2026	47.9
European Travel Commission	Industry association	260	29	2016–2026	0.0
Caribbean Tourism Organization	Industry association	638	20	2016–2026	100.0
Hospitality Net	Trade media	2139	720	2016–2026	0.0
Travel Weekly	Trade media	1106	104	2016–2026	100.0

2.2 Data collection

Articles were collected automatically with a purpose-built Python crawler that identifies itself as an academic research tool, waits at least three seconds between requests to the same website, honours rate-limit responses and records every request. Collection is resumable, and each saved document keeps its source URL, retrieval time and raw copy for checking. Three routes were used, chosen per website according to what each site makes available:

1. **Live websites.** Article URLs were listed from each site's XML sitemaps and its paginated news, press-release and blog archives, then downloaded directly (UN Tourism, WTTC, PATA, AHLA, ETC and Hospitality Net).
2. **Random sample of Hospitality Net articles.** Hospitality Net publishes several thousand items a year and numbers them sequentially, but its archive pages only reach back a few months. To cover 2016–

2026 evenly, 1,800 article numbers were drawn at random across the whole numbering range and each was downloaded from the live site, giving an unbiased sample of the publisher's output over the decade.

3. **Web archive (Internet Archive Wayback Machine).** The Caribbean Tourism Organization and Travel Weekly block automated access, and the older press-release archives of WTTC (before 2019), AHLA and PATA (before 2020) no longer exist on the live sites. For these, the Wayback Machine's index was used to list the archived article pages, and the archived copy of each page was retrieved. Travel Weekly publishes far more than can be read, so up to 170 articles were sampled at random per year. The publication date is always taken from the article itself; archived copies are labelled as such in the data.

In total 11,528 documents were collected, of which 9,060 articles from 8 websites are analysed (about 30% retrieved from the web archive). IH&RA could not contribute: its website contains no original news in the study period, and the "News" page of its former site (ih-ra.org) only republished short Hospitality Net headlines. This gap is reported rather than filled with other material.

2.3 Data preparation

For each page the headline, publication date and main text were extracted, using the publisher's structured metadata where present and site-specific rules otherwise. Navigation, contact details, "about us" boilerplate and social-media footers were removed. A document entered the analysis only if it was in English, had a verifiable publication date inside the study period and contained at least 120 words of text. Duplicates were removed in two steps: identical texts, then near-identical versions of the same story (cosine similarity of 0.94 or more on TF-IDF word vectors), so that a press release republished on several pages counts once per website and year. Of the 9,389 documents that passed these checks, 9,060 unique articles remain.

2.4 Identifying themes

Themes were measured with a transparent dictionary (codebook version 1.1, Appendix A) of 19 themes, each defined by a list of words and phrases — for example *sustainability, carbon, net zero, biodiversity* for "Sustainability & climate" or *artificial intelligence, generative AI, machine learning, chatbot* for "Artificial intelligence". The list started from the examples in the brief (sustainability, AI, social media) and the tourism literature, and was refined by reading samples of matched and unmatched articles and by comparing it with themes found without a dictionary (section 2.7). Generic institutional activity such as partnerships and memoranda of understanding is not counted as a theme. After the validation reading (section 2.7) the terms of four themes were narrowed once (codebook version 1.1): bare "jobs" and "employment", which mostly occur in economic-impact statements, no longer count as workforce discussion, and generic words such as "culture" (as in company culture), "connectivity" and "diversity" were replaced by more specific phrases.

Because a single passing mention does not make an article *about* a theme, an article counts as **discussing** a theme only when a theme term appears in the headline, appears at least twice in the opening 80 words, or appears at least three times using at least two different terms. An article can discuss several themes. The basic measure is the **share of articles discussing each theme**. Because the websites publish very different volumes, shares are calculated within each website first and then averaged with equal weight per website (only websites with at least 20 articles in the period concerned are included). This stops the largest publishers from determining the overall picture.

- **Q1, current themes:** themes ranked by their equal-weighted share in the last twelve months.
- **Q2, themes over time:** the same share calculated for each calendar year from 2016 to 2026, with the five leading themes of each year. 2016 (10 October–31 December) and 2026 (to 10 October) are partial years.

- **Q3, themes by website:** each website's share of articles discussing each theme over the whole period, and a distinctiveness ratio: the website's share divided by the average share on the other websites (2.0 = twice as common as elsewhere).

2.5 Sentiment

Sentiment was measured with a transformer language model trained for three-class sentiment classification (*twitter-roberta-base-sentiment-latest*, Loureiro et al. 2022), which reads each sentence in context rather than counting positive and negative words. Up to five sentences that mention a theme an article discusses were scored, and the article's tone towards that theme is the average of their negative, neutral and positive probabilities — so an article that welcomes AI but warns about job losses contributes to two themes with different tones. Sentences mentioning a brand were scored in the same way. Results are summarised as the share of articles that are positive, neutral and negative and as *net sentiment* (positive minus negative share). The model was chosen after testing four candidates against the validation reading described in section 2.7; the widely used VADER word-list method over-rated the positivity of business news and was rejected. Organisational communication is strongly positive by design, so differences between themes are more informative than absolute levels.

2.6 Brands and their associations

Brand mentions were counted with a dictionary of 93 brand families. It contains every company in the Global Brands Magazine list "Top 10 Tourism Brands in the World (2026)" — Booking Holdings, Hilton, Marriott International, Airbnb, Expedia Group, Hyatt, IHG Hotels & Resorts, Disney, Trip.com Group and Accor — together with their flagship sub-brands named in that article (for example Ritz-Carlton, Sheraton and Westin under Marriott International, or Agoda and KAYAK under Booking Holdings), plus other hotel companies, airlines, cruise lines, tour operators and travel-technology firms. Sub-brands are grouped under their 2026 owner. Ambiguous names (for example "Hilton Head", "United Arab Emirates") are filtered out. For each brand family we report the number of articles mentioning it and the websites it appears on. **Associations** are measured from the text around each mention (the sentence containing the brand plus one sentence either side): the share of the brand's articles in which each theme appears in that window, and the *lift* — how much more often the theme appears around this brand than around brands in general. We also list the words most distinctive of each brand's context (log-odds ratio with an informative Dirichlet prior, Monroe et al. 2008), the sentiment of sentences mentioning the brand, and which brands are named together in the same article.

2.7 Cross-checks and validation

As an independent check on the dictionary, an unsupervised topic model (TF-IDF with non-negative matrix factorisation, 20 topics, trained on a balanced sample of at most 120 articles per website and year) was fitted without any predefined themes (Appendix B). For 12 of the 20 topics, at least half of the articles in the topic discuss a single dictionary theme (for example Travel demand & economic performance, Policy, regulation & visas, COVID-19 pandemic and Workforce, skills & education), so the themes found without a dictionary largely coincide with the codebook. The remaining topics group articles by publisher-specific subjects (for example thailand, bangkok, event, time, want, booking and resort, guests, resorts) rather than by industry themes. Automated consistency checks confirm that every article lies inside the study period, that no story is counted twice for a website and year, and that all tables add up.

Validation sample. To check the automated coding, a stratified random sample of 64 articles (8 per website) was read and coded independently of the dictionary, recording which themes each article is substantially about, together with the tone of 120 randomly chosen theme sentences. Against this reading the "discussing" rule achieved a precision of 75% (share of automated assignments confirmed) and a recall of 71% (share of

the reader's themes that the rule also found); counting every passing mention instead would give a precision of only 37%. The sentiment model agreed with the reader's positive/neutral/negative judgement for 85% of sentences (VADER: 56%). The independent reading was carried out with the help of an AI language model and should be complemented by a human check before publication. Because the codebook was revised once after this reading, these figures are partly in-sample and somewhat optimistic. Per-theme results are in `tables/validation_by_theme.csv`.

3. Results

3.1 Ten key themes in the current discussion

Figure 1 ranks the themes by the share of articles that discuss them in the last twelve months. **Travel demand & economic performance**, **Sustainability & climate** and **Safety, security & crisis resilience** lead, followed by Air, cruise & connectivity, Workforce, skills & education, Investment & hotel development, Inclusion, community & accessibility, Culture, heritage & gastronomy, Guest experience & wellness and Policy, regulation & visas. Table 2 also shows the share when all articles are simply pooled, which gives the high-volume trade-media sites more weight: Guest experience & wellness and Artificial intelligence then rank higher, and Safety, security & crisis resilience and Sustainability & climate lower. The equal-website ranking is used as the main result because it treats each community's agenda as equally important.

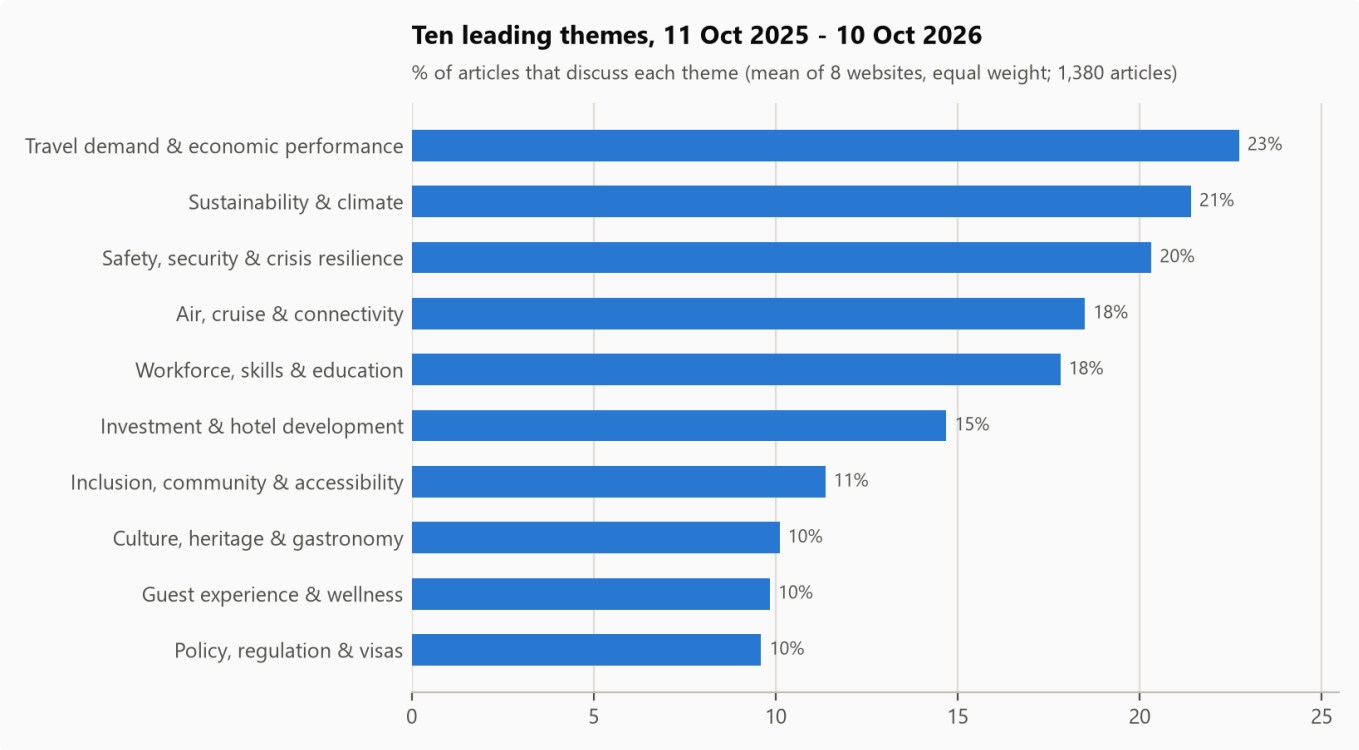


Figure 1. Ten leading themes, 11 October 2025 – 10 October 2026: share of articles discussing each theme, equal weight per website.

Table 2. The ten leading themes, 11 October 2025 – 10 October 2026 (1,380 articles).

#	Theme	% of articles (equal weight)	% of all articles pooled	Websites	% positive	% negative	Net sentiment
1	Travel demand & economic performance	22.7	18.6	8	34.0	1.9	32.0
2	Sustainability & climate	21.4	11.9	8	61.6	0.6	61.0
3	Safety, security & crisis resilience	20.3	8.9	8	35.0	4.9	30.1
4	Air, cruise & connectivity	18.5	12.5	8	31.8	4.0	27.8
5	Workforce, skills & education	17.8	19.6	7	41.5	4.1	37.4
6	Investment & hotel development	14.7	21.0	7	33.1	2.1	31.0
7	Inclusion, community & accessibility	11.4	6.3	8	70.1	1.1	69.0
8	Culture, heritage & gastronomy	10.1	8.9	7	73.2	0.0	73.2
9	Guest experience & wellness	9.8	22.8	7	40.1	1.0	39.2
10	Policy, regulation & visas	9.6	6.5	5	29.2	6.7	22.5

Sentiment. Negative tone is rare for all ten themes (Figure 2): most sentences are neutral, factual reporting, and the rest is mostly positive, reflecting the promotional nature of association and trade communication. Relative differences are informative: across the whole period the most positive themes are Culture, heritage & gastronomy, Inclusion, community & accessibility and Sustainability & climate, while the least positive are Costs, inflation & affordability, COVID-19 pandemic and Policy, regulation & visas — themes that by their nature describe threats, shocks and pressures.

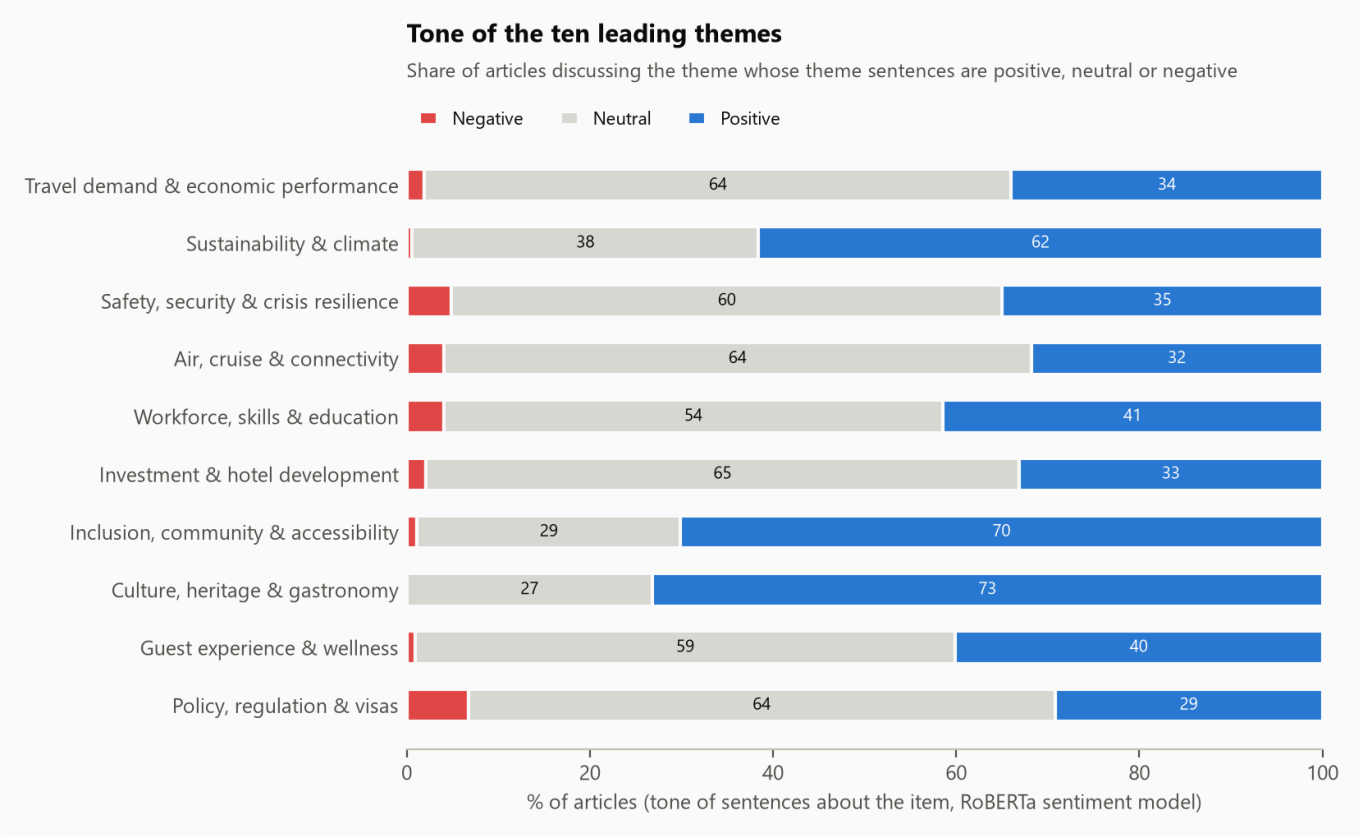


Figure 2. Sentiment of the ten leading themes: share of articles whose sentences about the theme are negative, neutral or positive (RoBERTa sentiment model).

3.2 Key themes over time, 2016–2026

Figure 3 shows how prominent each theme was in each year; the outlined cells are each year's top three, and Table 3 lists the five leading themes per year. The leading theme changes in clear phases — 2016: **Culture, heritage & gastronomy**; 2017–2018: **Workforce, skills & education**; 2019: **Travel demand & economic performance**; 2020–2022: **COVID-19 pandemic**; 2023–2025: **Sustainability & climate**; 2026: **Travel demand & economic performance**. COVID-19 was the leading theme in 2020–2022, peaking at 58% of articles in 2020, and remained visible through the recovery period as “post-pandemic” recovery language. Sustainability & climate was in first or second place in 2017, 2023, 2024 and 2025.

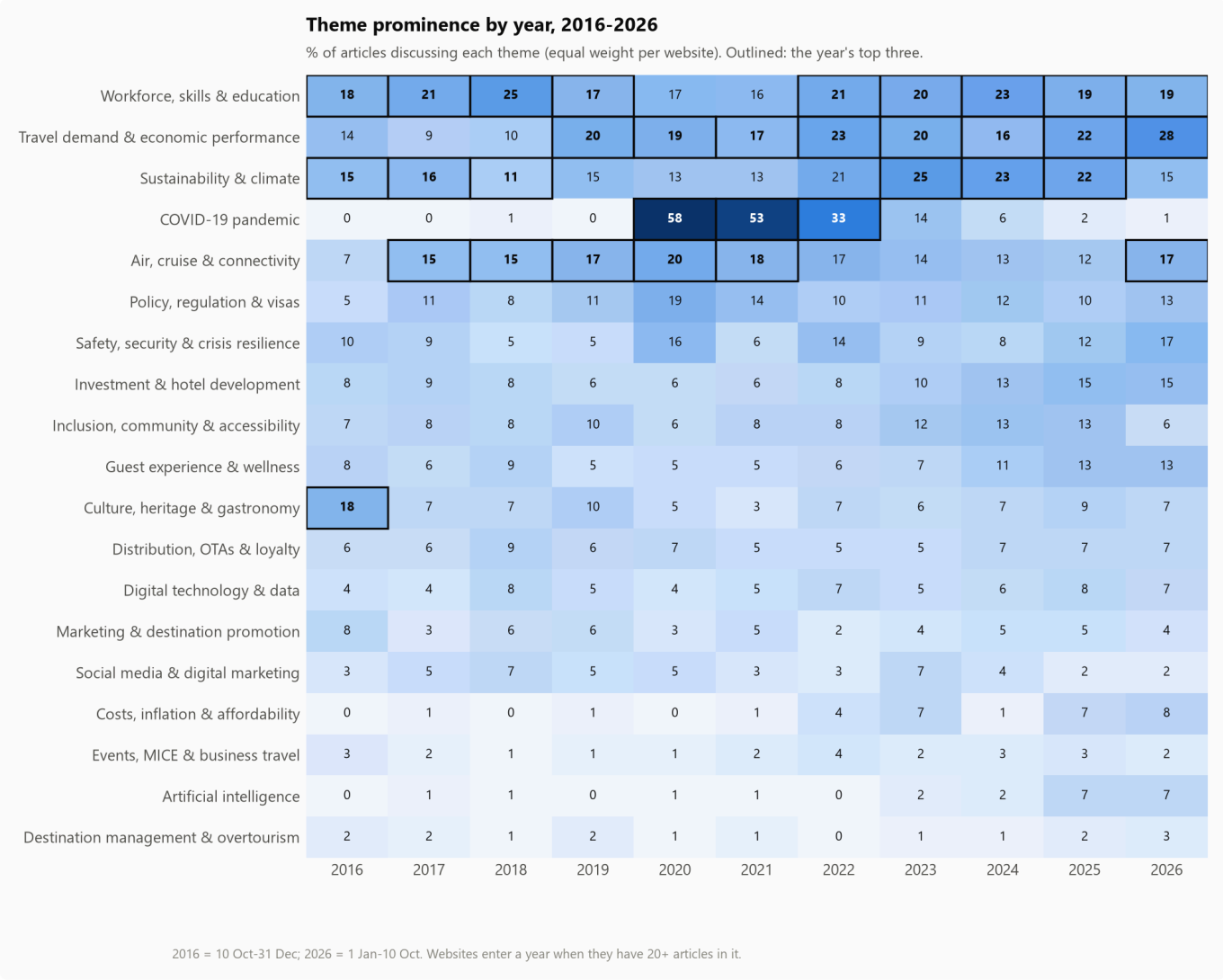


Figure 3. Share of articles discussing each theme, by year (equal weight per website). Outlined: the three leading themes of each year.

Table 3. The five leading themes in each year.

Year	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	Websites
2016	Culture, heritage & gastronomy	Workforce, skills & education	Sustainability & climate	Travel demand & economic performance	Safety, security & crisis resilience	3
2017	Workforce, skills & education	Sustainability & climate	Air, cruise & connectivity	Policy, regulation & visas	Travel demand & economic performance	6
2018	Workforce, skills & education	Air, cruise & connectivity	Sustainability & climate	Travel demand & economic performance	Guest experience & wellness	6
2019	Travel demand & economic performance	Workforce, skills & education	Air, cruise & connectivity	Sustainability & climate	Policy, regulation & visas	8
2020	COVID-19 pandemic	Air, cruise & connectivity	Travel demand & economic performance	Policy, regulation & visas	Workforce, skills & education	8
2021	COVID-19 pandemic	Air, cruise & connectivity	Travel demand & economic performance	Workforce, skills & education	Policy, regulation & visas	8
2022	COVID-19 pandemic	Travel demand & economic performance	Workforce, skills & education	Sustainability & climate	Air, cruise & connectivity	8
2023	Sustainability & climate	Workforce, skills & education	Travel demand & economic performance	Air, cruise & connectivity	COVID-19 pandemic	8
2024	Sustainability & climate	Workforce, skills & education	Travel demand & economic performance	Inclusion, community & accessibility	Investment & hotel development	7

Year	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	Websites
2025	Sustainability & climate	Travel demand & economic performance	Workforce, skills & education	Investment & hotel development	Inclusion, community & accessibility	7
2026	Travel demand & economic performance	Workforce, skills & education	Air, cruise & connectivity	Safety, security & crisis resilience	Sustainability & climate	6

Comparing the three years before the pandemic (2017–19) with the three most recent full years (2023–25) shows which concerns have grown (Table 4). The largest increases are in Sustainability & climate (+9 points), Travel demand & economic performance (+6 points), Investment & hotel development (+5 points) and Costs, inflation & affordability (+4 points); the largest decreases in Air, cruise & connectivity (-3 points), Social media & digital marketing (-1 points) and Culture, heritage & gastronomy (-1 points). Figure 4 traces selected themes: artificial intelligence was discussed in at most 0.8% of articles in any year before 2023 and reached 7% in 2026, while the pandemic theme rose to 58% in 2020 and fell to 6% or less from 2024.

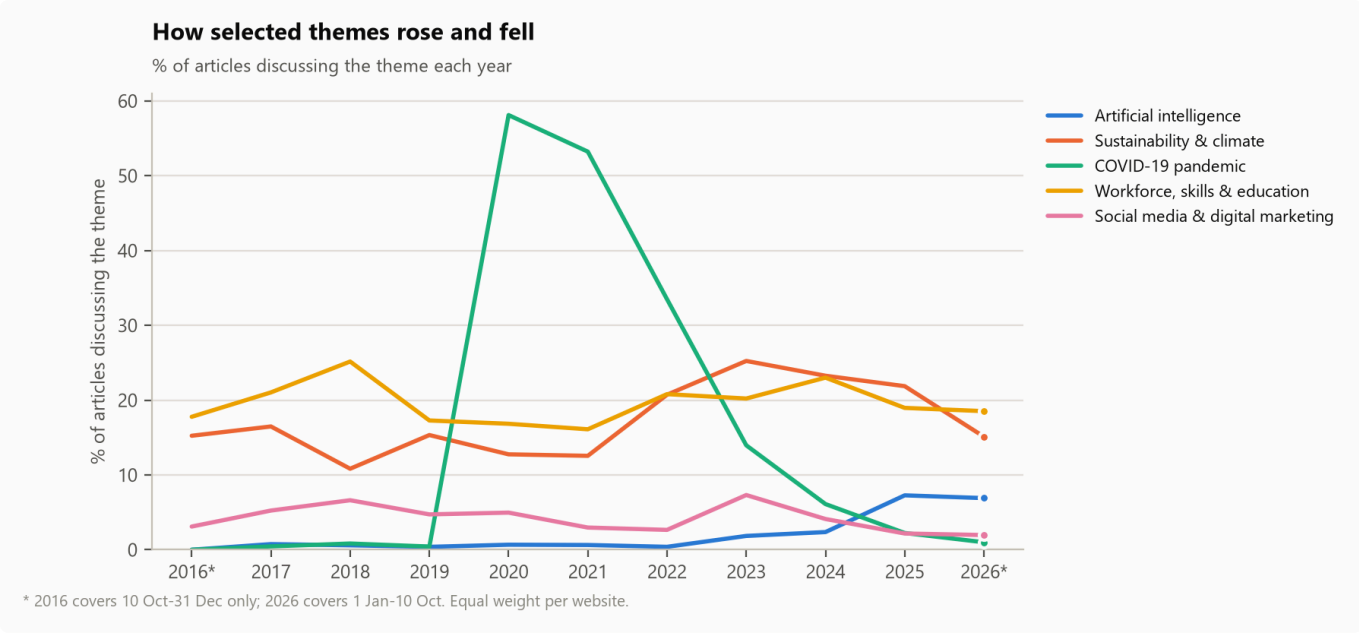


Figure 4. Selected themes over time: share of articles discussing each theme (equal weight per website).

Table 4. Change in theme prominence, 2017–19 vs 2023–25.

Theme	2017–19 (% of articles)	2023–25 (% of articles)	Change (points)
Sustainability & climate	14.2	23.5	9.2
COVID-19 pandemic	0.6	7.4	6.9
Travel demand & economic performance	13.2	19.2	5.9
Investment & hotel development	7.7	12.9	5.1
Costs, inflation & affordability	0.6	4.8	4.2
Inclusion, community & accessibility	8.7	12.8	4.1
Guest experience & wellness	6.6	10.2	3.7
Safety, security & crisis resilience	6.2	9.6	3.4
Artificial intelligence	0.6	3.8	3.2
Events, MICE & business travel	1.2	2.7	1.5
Policy, regulation & visas	10.0	11.2	1.3
Digital technology & data	5.4	6.3	0.9
Destination management & overtourism	1.5	1.3	-0.2

Theme	2017–19 (% of articles)	2023–25 (% of articles)	Change (points)
Marketing & destination promotion	4.7	4.4	-0.4
Workforce, skills & education	21.2	20.7	-0.4
Distribution, OTAs & loyalty	6.9	6.3	-0.6
Culture, heritage & gastronomy	8.1	7.2	-0.8
Social media & digital marketing	5.5	4.5	-1.0
Air, cruise & connectivity	15.9	12.9	-3.0

Robustness: because not every website covers every year, the yearly figures were recalculated using only the websites present in every year from 2017 to 2025 (UN Tourism; PATA; AHLA; Hospitality Net; Travel Weekly). The leading theme is the same in 5 of 11 years and at least two of the top three themes are the same in 10 of 11 years; the differences come mainly from leaving out WTTC, ETC and CTO, whose agendas are distinctive (results in the workbook, sheet 9).

3.3 Key themes on each website

The websites serve different communities and their agendas differ accordingly (Figure 5, Table 5). The ratio in the last column shows the themes each site discusses much more than the others do — a summary of what makes each community distinctive.

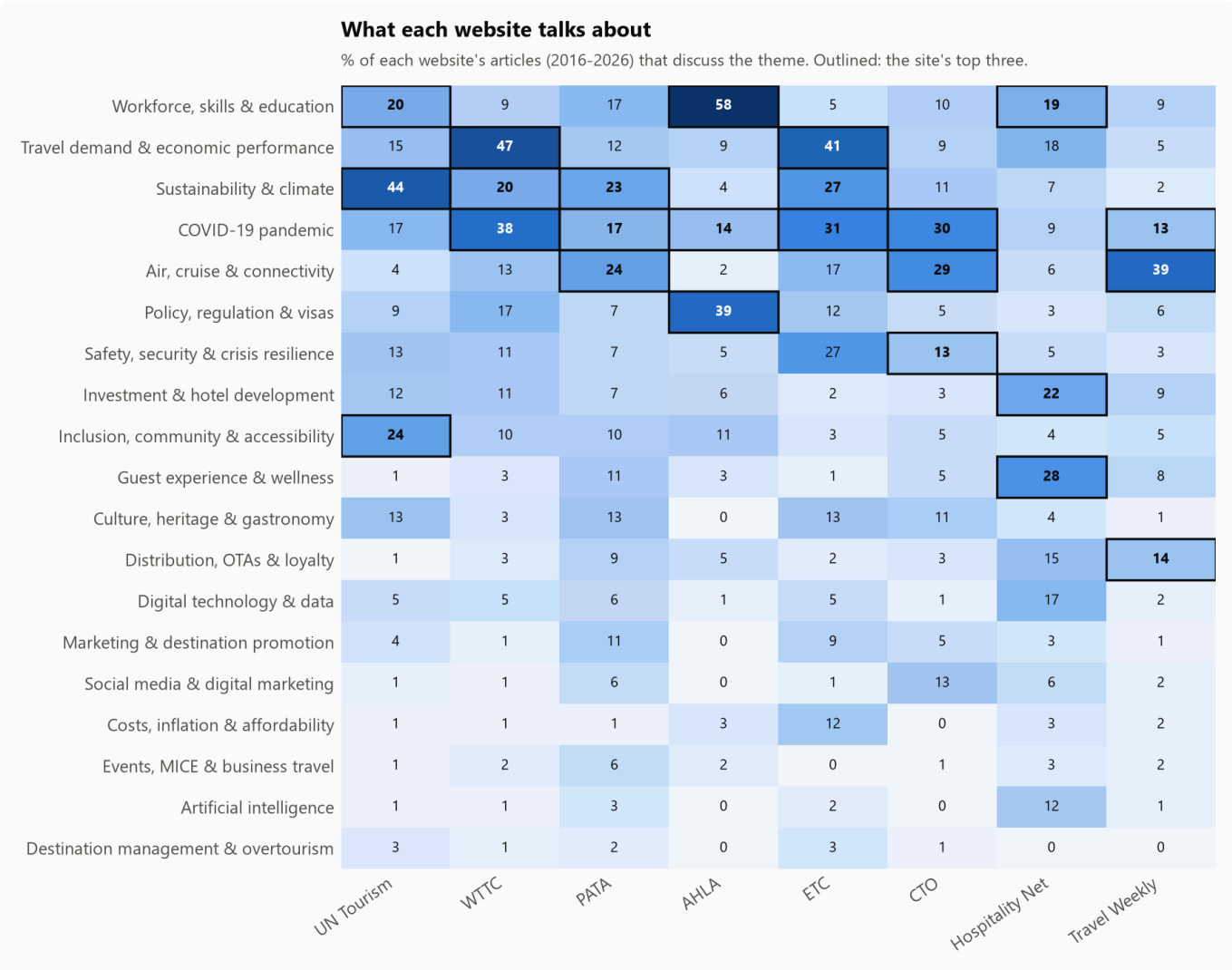


Figure 5. Share of each website's articles discussing each theme, 2016–2026. Outlined: each website's three leading themes.

Table 5. Leading and most distinctive themes of each website (share of the site's articles).

Website	Articles	Leading theme	Second	Third	Most distinctive (× other sites)

Website	Articles	Leading theme	Second	Third	Most distinctive (× other sites)
UN Tourism	1305	Sustainability & climate (44%)	Inclusion, community & accessibility (24%)	Workforce, skills & education (20%)	Inclusion, community & accessibility (3.6x); Sustainability & climate (3.3x); Culture, heritage & gastronomy (2.1x)
WTTC	733	Travel demand & economic performance (47%)	COVID-19 pandemic (38%)	Sustainability & climate (20%)	Travel demand & economic performance (3.0x); COVID-19 pandemic (2.0x); Policy, regulation & visas (1.4x)
PATA	2344	Air, cruise & connectivity (24%)	Sustainability & climate (23%)	COVID-19 pandemic (17%)	Marketing & destination promotion (3.2x); Culture, heritage & gastronomy (2.0x); Guest experience & wellness (1.6x)
AHLA	535	Workforce, skills & education (58%)	Policy, regulation & visas (39%)	COVID-19 pandemic (14%)	Workforce, skills & education (4.6x); Policy, regulation & visas (4.5x); Inclusion, community & accessibility (1.3x)
ETC	260	Travel demand & economic performance (41%)	COVID-19 pandemic (31%)	Sustainability & climate (27%)	Costs, inflation & affordability (8.4x); Safety, security & crisis resilience (3.2x); Travel demand & economic performance (2.5x)
CTO	638	COVID-19 pandemic (30%)	Air, cruise & connectivity (29%)	Safety, security & crisis resilience (13%)	Social media & digital marketing (5.3x); Air, cruise & connectivity (2.0x); Culture, heritage & gastronomy (1.6x)
Hospitality Net	2139	Guest experience & wellness (28%)	Investment & hotel development (22%)	Workforce, skills & education (19%)	Artificial intelligence (9.3x); Guest experience & wellness (6.0x); Digital technology & data (4.6x)
Travel Weekly	1106	Air, cruise & connectivity (39%)	Distribution, OTAs & loyalty (14%)	COVID-19 pandemic (13%)	Air, cruise & connectivity (2.9x); Distribution, OTAs & loyalty (2.6x); COVID-19 pandemic (0.6x)

- **UN Tourism** (1,305 articles): focuses on Sustainability & climate, Inclusion, community & accessibility and Workforce, skills & education; its most distinctive theme compared with the other sites is Inclusion, community & accessibility.
- **WTTC** (733 articles): focuses on Travel demand & economic performance, COVID-19 pandemic and Sustainability & climate; its most distinctive theme compared with the other sites is Travel demand & economic performance.
- **PATA** (2,344 articles): focuses on Air, cruise & connectivity, Sustainability & climate and COVID-19 pandemic; its most distinctive theme compared with the other sites is Marketing & destination promotion.
- **AHLA** (535 articles): focuses on Workforce, skills & education, Policy, regulation & visas and COVID-19 pandemic; its most distinctive theme compared with the other sites is Workforce, skills & education.
- **ETC** (260 articles): focuses on Travel demand & economic performance, COVID-19 pandemic and Sustainability & climate; its most distinctive theme compared with the other sites is Costs, inflation & affordability.
- **CTO** (638 articles): focuses on COVID-19 pandemic, Air, cruise & connectivity and Safety, security & crisis resilience; its most distinctive theme compared with the other sites is Social media & digital marketing.
- **Hospitality Net** (2,139 articles): focuses on Guest experience & wellness, Investment & hotel development and Workforce, skills & education; its most distinctive theme compared with the other sites is Artificial intelligence.
- **Travel Weekly** (1,106 articles): focuses on Air, cruise & connectivity, Distribution, OTAs & loyalty and COVID-19 pandemic; its most distinctive theme compared with the other sites is Air, cruise & connectivity.

3.4 Key brands and their associations

Figure 6 shows how often each company in the Global Brands Magazine 2026 top ten is discussed, counting any of its brands. Table 6 adds the websites where they appear, the themes discussed around them and the tone of those sentences. Companies are named most often on Travel Weekly (61% of articles) and Hospitality Net (51% of articles) and least often on UN Tourism (11%) and ETC (8%).

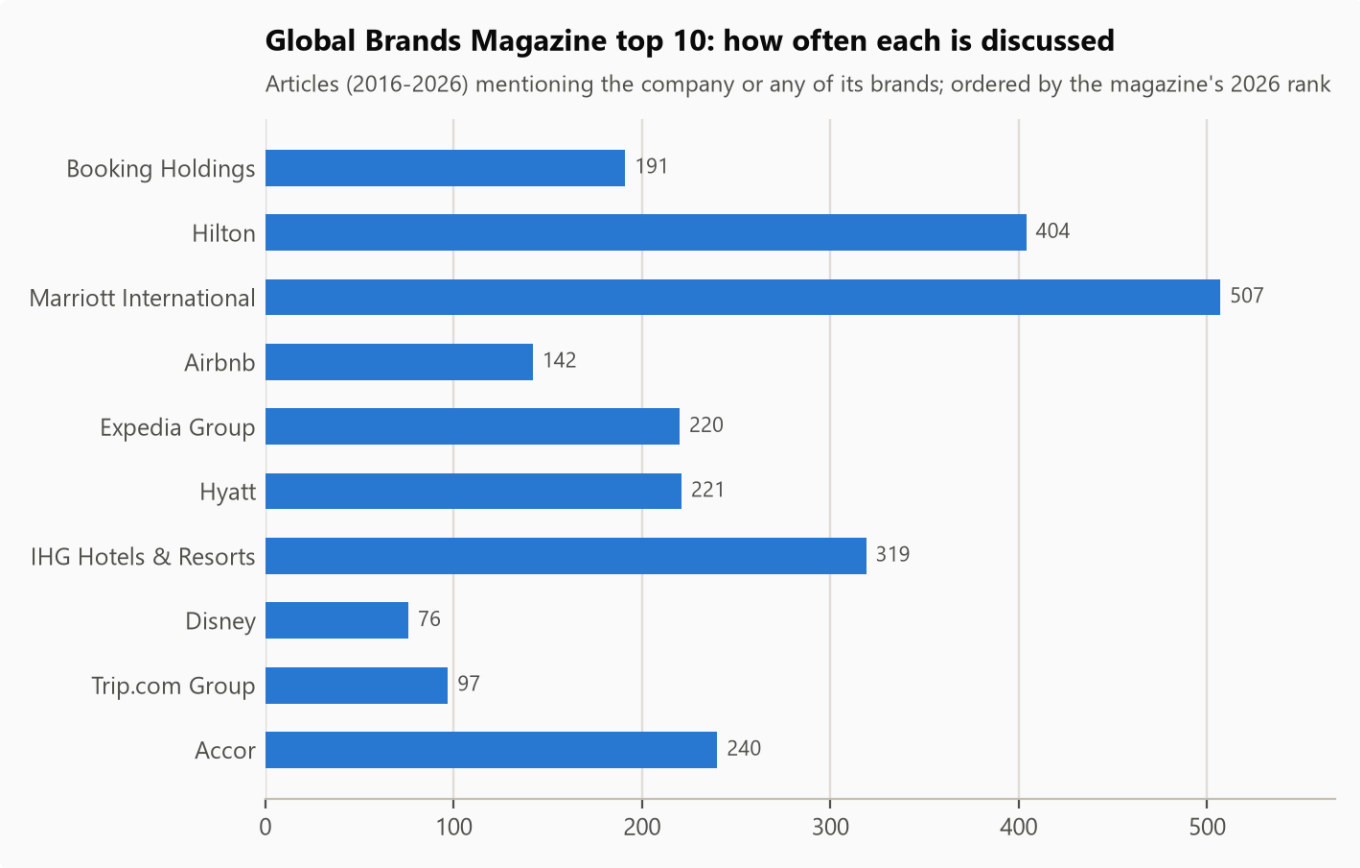


Figure 6. Articles mentioning each Global Brands Magazine top-10 company (any of its brands), 2016–2026, in the magazine's rank order.

Table 6. The Global Brands Magazine top 10 in the corpus.

GBM rank	Brand	Articles	Websites	Themes discussed around the brand (share of its articles, lift)	Net sentiment
1	Booking Holdings	191	8	Distribution, OTAs & loyalty (37%, 2.0x); Artificial intelligence (24%, 3.0x); Air, cruise & connectivity (19%, 0.6x)	17.3
2	Hilton	404	8	Guest experience & wellness (27%, 1.3x); Investment & hotel development (24%, 1.2x); Air, cruise & connectivity (18%, 0.5x)	35.8
3	Marriott International	507	8	Guest experience & wellness (31%, 1.5x); Investment & hotel development (28%, 1.4x); Workforce, skills & education (16%, 1.2x)	26.6
4	Airbnb	142	8	Distribution, OTAs & loyalty (35%, 1.9x); Policy, regulation & visas (27%, 3.6x); Investment & hotel development (20%, 1.0x)	29.6
5	Expedia Group	220	8	Distribution, OTAs & loyalty (41%, 2.2x); Air, cruise & connectivity (22%, 0.6x); Artificial intelligence (18%, 2.3x)	21.4
6	Hyatt	221	7	Guest experience & wellness (27%, 1.3x); Investment & hotel development (23%, 1.1x); Workforce, skills & education (20%, 1.5x)	32.0
7	IHG Hotels & Resorts	319	8	Guest experience & wellness (30%, 1.4x); Investment & hotel development (27%, 1.4x); Air, cruise & connectivity (22%, 0.6x)	32.5
8	Disney	76	6	Air, cruise & connectivity (28%, 0.8x); Guest experience & wellness (16%, 0.8x); Workforce, skills & education (16%, 1.1x)	50.0
9	Trip.com Group	97	6	Air, cruise & connectivity (32%, 0.9x); Guest experience & wellness (23%, 1.1x); Sustainability & climate (22%, 1.5x)	27.4
10	Accor	240	7	Investment & hotel development (32%, 1.6x); Guest experience & wellness (27%, 1.3x); Sustainability & climate (20%, 1.4x)	33.2

Table 7. Which of each company's brands are discussed, and the vocabulary that distinguishes it.

Brand	Sub-brands mentioned (articles)	Most distinctive words around the brand
Booking Holdings	Booking.com (143); Agoda (34); Booking Holdings (32); Priceline (19); OpenTable (12); KAYAK (3)	cheaper, com's, travelers, respondents, bookings, online, accommodation, reduced, commission, connected
Hilton	Hilton (379); Waldorf Astoria (34); Hampton (29); Curio Collection (23); DoubleTree (22); Embassy Suites (11)	chocolate, projects, rooms, bar, award-winning, fitness, amenities, fulfilling, room, hospitable
Marriott International	Marriott (398); Ritz-Carlton (65); Sheraton (49); Starwood (45); Westin (37); St. Regis (22)	keys, portfolio, scheduled, properties, rooms, members, select-service, earn, associates, design
Airbnb	Airbnb (142)	hosts, listings, short-term, rentals, tax, rental, sharing, communities, housing, homes
Expedia Group	Expedia (194); Hotels.com (28); Vrbo (23); Orbitz (13); trivago (13); Egencia (4)	online, websites, sites, hosts, bookings, advertising, consumers, localized, rental, research
Hyatt	Hyatt (217); Andaz (11); Alila (9); Thompson Hotels (7)	guestrooms, luxury, lifestyle, all-inclusive, executed, resort, culinary, openings, gastronomy, wellbeing
IHG Hotels & Resorts	IHG (193); InterContinental (70); Holiday Inn (62); Kimpton (33); Six Senses (30); Crowne Plaza (29)	children, rooms, pipeline, projects, broad, open, tea, manages, mainstream, globally
Disney	Disney (76)	parks, park, attraction, theme, attractions, film, fiscal, themed, land, ships
Trip.com Group	Trip.com (79); Skyscanner (25); Qunar (9)	travellers, report, travel-related, cost-effective, consisting, aggregation, apps, informed, comprising, platforms
Accor	Accor (174); Fairmont (32); Sofitel (20); ibis (20); Pullman (15); Novotel (14)	rooms, lifestyle, plastic, cancer, projects, courtesy, situated, women, mobility, augmented

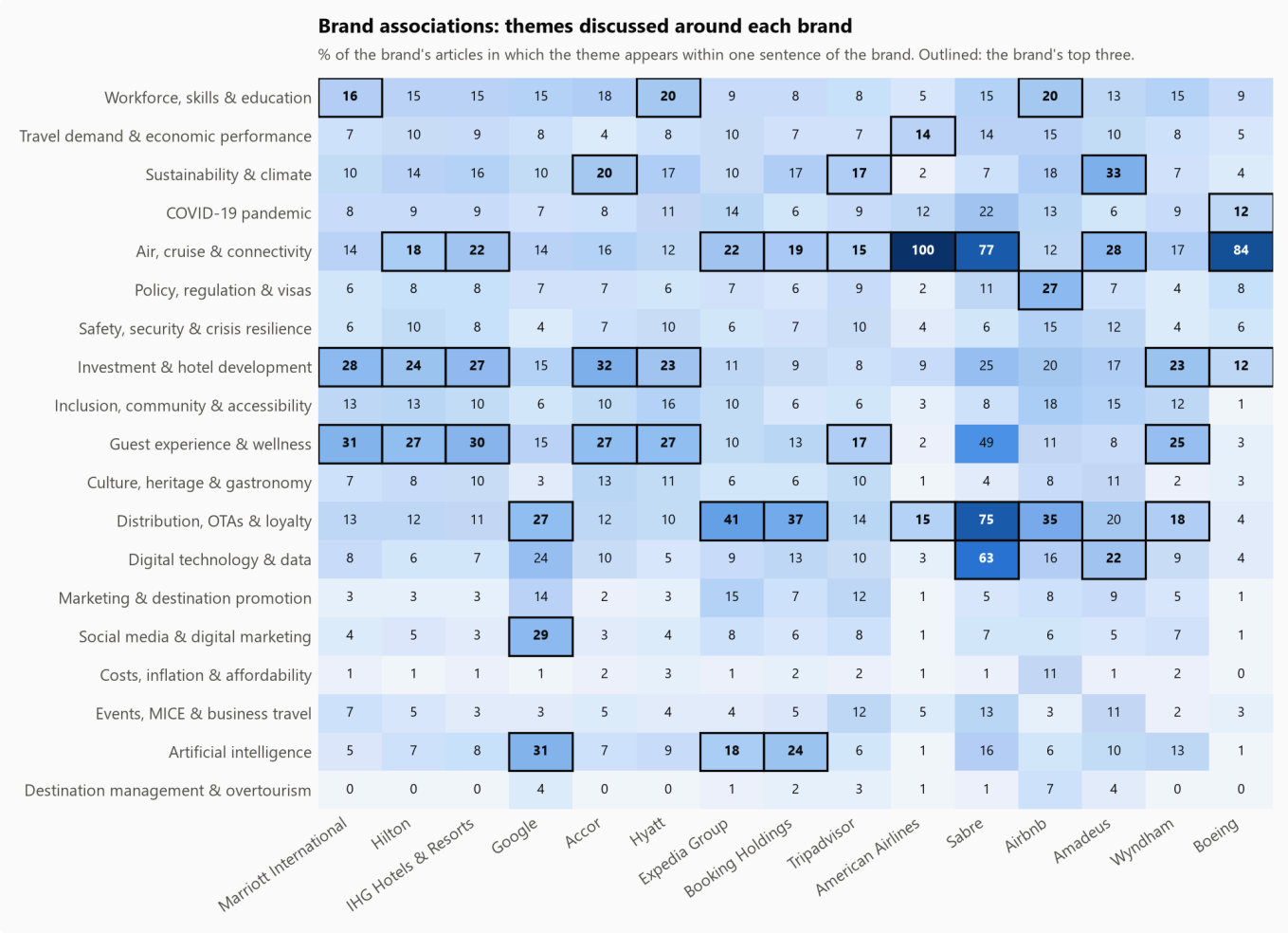


Figure 7. Brand associations: share of each brand family's articles in which a theme appears within one sentence of the brand. Outlined: each brand's three most frequent themes.

Read together, the association measures give a profile of each brand in industry discussion:

- **Marriott International** (507 articles): discussed with Guest experience & wellness, Investment & hotel development and Workforce, skills & education; characteristic words: *keys, portfolio, scheduled, properties, rooms, members*.
- **Hilton** (404 articles): discussed with Guest experience & wellness, Investment & hotel development and Air, cruise & connectivity; characteristic words: *chocolate, projects, rooms, bar, award-winning, fitness*.
- **IHG Hotels & Resorts** (319 articles): discussed with Guest experience & wellness, Investment & hotel development and Air, cruise & connectivity; characteristic words: *children, rooms, pipeline, projects, broad, open*.
- **Accor** (240 articles): discussed with Investment & hotel development, Guest experience & wellness and Sustainability & climate; characteristic words: *rooms, lifestyle, plastic, cancer, projects, courtesy*.
- **Hyatt** (221 articles): discussed with Guest experience & wellness, Investment & hotel development and Workforce, skills & education; characteristic words: *guestrooms, luxury, lifestyle, all-inclusive, executed, resort*.
- **Expedia Group** (220 articles): discussed with Distribution, OTAs & loyalty, Air, cruise & connectivity and Artificial intelligence; characteristic words: *online, websites, sites, hosts, bookings, advertising*.
- **Booking Holdings** (191 articles): discussed with Distribution, OTAs & loyalty, Artificial intelligence and Air, cruise & connectivity; characteristic words: *cheaper, com's, travelers, respondents, bookings, online*.
- **Airbnb** (142 articles): discussed with Distribution, OTAs & loyalty, Policy, regulation & visas and Investment & hotel development; characteristic words: *hosts, listings, short-term, rentals, tax, rental*.

- **Trip.com Group** (97 articles): discussed with Air, cruise & connectivity, Guest experience & wellness and Sustainability & climate; characteristic words: *travellers, report, travel-related, cost-effective, consisting, aggregation*.
- **Disney** (76 articles): discussed with Air, cruise & connectivity, Guest experience & wellness and Workforce, skills & education; characteristic words: *parks, park, attraction, theme, attractions, film*.

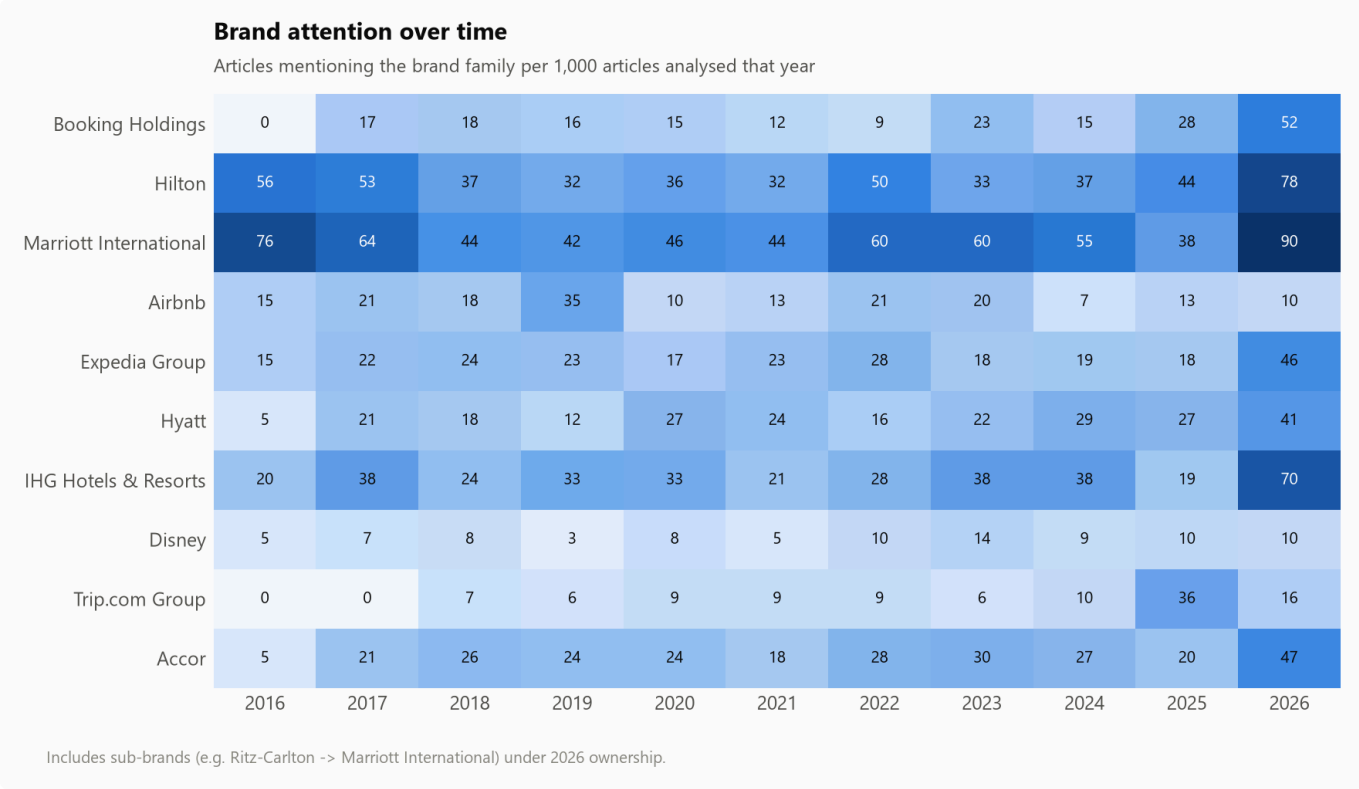


Figure 8. Attention to the Global Brands Magazine top 10 over time: articles mentioning the brand per 1,000 articles analysed in that year.

Other prominent names. Beyond the magazine's list, the most frequently discussed companies are Google (290), Tripadvisor (185), American Airlines (171), Sabre (167), Amadeus (134), Wyndham (117), Boeing (112), Dusit (111), JetBlue (105) and STR (94) — mostly travel-technology firms, airlines and regional hotel groups. The brands most often named together in the same article are Hilton and Marriott International (201 articles), IHG Hotels & Resorts and Marriott International (136 articles), Hyatt and Marriott International (132 articles) and Hilton and IHG Hotels & Resorts (119 articles).

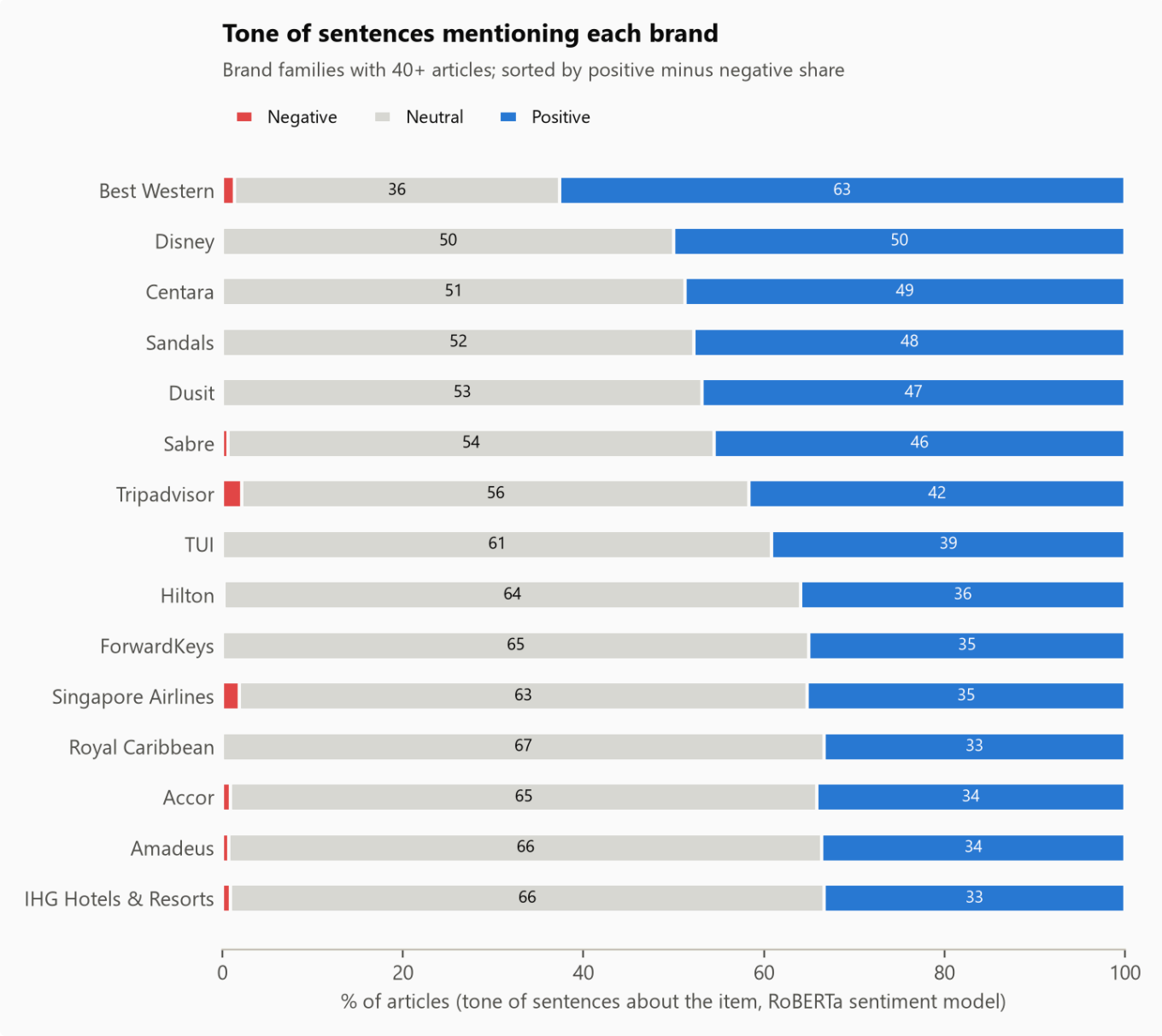


Figure 9. Tone of sentences mentioning each brand family (brands with at least 40 articles).

Industry bodies. Among organisations other than the publisher itself, the most frequently mentioned are UN Tourism / UNWTO (328 articles), IATA (313 articles), European Commission / EU (297 articles), UNESCO (218 articles), WTTC (198 articles) and World Health Organization (140 articles) (full list in the workbook, sheet 18).

4. Limitations

- **What is measured.** The results describe what these nine organisations and publishers write about, not the opinions of travellers or the whole industry. Press releases are written to promote, which is why negative tone is rare.
- **Coverage differs by website.** Volumes and years covered differ (Appendix C). Equal weighting per website prevents large publishers from dominating, but the set of websites contributing to each year changes; the fixed-panel check in section 3.2 shows the main trends are robust to this. IH&RA has no original content in the period. Some archived pages could not be retrieved.
- **Samples, not censuses.** Hospitality Net and Travel Weekly were sampled at random; other websites were collected as completely as their sitemaps, archives and the web archive allow. Removed pages

cannot be recovered.

- **Dictionary methods.** Theme and brand dictionaries are transparent and reproducible but can miss unusual wording and occasionally match an unrelated use of a word; the "discussing" rule and the validation sample reduce, but do not remove, this error. Sentiment is measured on wording, so sarcasm or mixed statements are not always captured; on the validation sample the sentiment model disagreed with the reader for about one sentence in seven.
- **Brand ownership** is mapped to 2026 owners (for example Six Senses under IHG throughout), and co-occurrence in text indicates association in discussion, not a business relationship.

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Appendix A. Theme codebook (version 1.1)

The first terms of each theme are shown as regular expressions (the full list is in `output/codebook.json`). Matching ignores case except for abbreviations such as AI, OTA and MICE.

Theme	Example terms
Sustainability & climate	sustainab\w+, climate (change|action|crisis|emergency|goals?|targets?|neutral\w*|resilience), carbon, decarboni[sz]\w+, net[-]?zero, emissions?, biodiversity, nature[-]positive, circular economy, green (transition|economy|recovery|hotels?|travel|tourism|investment|buildings?), renewable energy, single[-]use plastics?, plastic (waste|pollution), food waste
Artificial intelligence	artificial intelligence, generative AI, gen[-]?AI, AI, machine learning, ChatGPT, large language models?, LLMs?, chatbots?, agentic, AI[-](powered|driven|enabled|agents?)
Digital technology & data	digital transformation, digiti[sz]ation, digitali[sz]ation, digital (tools?|platforms?|solutions?|innovation|identity|payments?|technolog\w+|channels?), (hotel|travel|hospitality|tourism) tech(nolog\w+)?, software, cloud[-](based|platform|computing|solutions?), big data, data analytics, analytics, cyber\w*, biometrics?, blockchain, mobile apps?
Social media & digital marketing	social media, social networks?, influencers?, Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, YouTube, Twitter, WeChat, Weibo, Xiaohongshu, user[-]generated content, content creators?, online reviews?
Marketing & destination promotion	marketing (campaigns?|strategy|strategies|activities|efforts), destination marketing, (tourism|destination) promotion, promotional (campaigns?|activities|events?), roadshows?, brand(ing|awareness| campaign| identity| positioning), advertising, (travel|trade|tourism) (fairs?|shows?|marts?), ITB, World Travel Market, WTM, Arabian Travel Market, fam(iliari[sz]ation)? trips?, source markets?
Workforce, skills & education	workforce, employees?, workers?, staffing, staff (shortages?|retention|training|members|housing), talent, recruit\w*, labou?r (shortages?|market|force|costs?|unions?), (trade|hotel|workers.?) unions?, unioni[sz]\w+, wages?, minimum wage, job (openings|vacancies|training|fairs?|seekers|losses|creation), skills?

Theme	Example terms
Travel demand & economic performance	arrivals?, (visitor|tourist|passenger) numbers?, international tourists?, occupancy, RevPAR, ADR, average daily rates?, (travel|tourism|hotel|leisure) demand, booking (momentum|growth|volumes? |trends?), GDP, economic (impact|contribution|growth|recovery|performance), (visitor|tourism|tourist|international) (spending|spend|receipts|expenditure), record (year|numbers|levels|highs?), outbound
COVID-19 pandemic	COVID(-19)?, coronavirus, pandemic, lockdowns?, quarantine, vaccin\w+, social distancing, reopen\w*, restart(ing)? (of)?(tourism|travel), Safe Travels, (health|safety|hygiene) protocols?, post[-]pandemic, Omicron, testing requirements?
Safety, security & crisis resilience	crisis, crises, disasters?, hurricanes?, earthquakes?, floods?, wildfires?, tsunami, terroris\w+, security, resilien\w+, emergency, conflicts?, war
Policy, regulation & visas	visas?, visa[-]free, e[-]?visas?, travel restrictions?, borders?, regulations?, regulatory, legislation, legislat(ive|ors?), congress(ional)?, senate, lawmakers, policy[-]?makers, (public|tourism|government) polic(y|ies)
Investment & hotel development	investments?, investors?, infrastructure, (hotel|resort) (developments?|openings?|pipeline|projects?), construction, financing, capital (expenditure|markets?|investment), real estate, acquisitions?, acquires?, acquired, mergers?, pipeline, signings?
Destination management & overtourism	destination management, DMOs?, over[-]?tourism, overcrowding, crowd management, visitor management, carrying capacity, seasonality, (visitor|tourist) dispersal, destination stewardship, tourism (planning|master plans?|strategy|strategies), destination (development|strategy|governance|competitiveness|management organi[sz]ations?), local residents, residents? (and|vs\.?|versus) (visitors|tourists)
Inclusion, community & accessibility	inclusi\w+, accessib\w+, gender, women, equality, diversity (and|&) inclusion, DEI, disabilit\w+, indigenous, local communit\w+, community[-]based, empowerment, empower(ing)? (women|communities|local), poverty
Culture, heritage & gastronomy	cultural (heritage|tourism|experiences?|events?|sites?|diversity|attractions?|identity|programmes? |programs?|offer\w*|exchanges?|assets?), (local|national|living|indigenous|rich|vibrant) cultures?, culture (and|&) (heritage|history|arts|tourism), heritage, UNESCO, museums?, gastronom\w+, culinary, food tourism, cuisine, wine tourism, festivals?, arts and culture, handicrafts?
Guest experience & wellness	guest experiences?, customer experiences?, personali[sz]\w+, guest satisfaction, service quality, luxury, wellness, well[-]?being, spas?, medical tourism, experiential, authentic experiences?, amenities, guest (needs|expectations|journey)
Air, cruise & connectivity	airlines?, aviation, airports?, air (connectivity|routes?|capacity|service|travel|transport|lift), flights?, cruise\w*, rail(ways?)?, high[-]speed rail, train (travel|services?|stations?|routes?), (air|airline|flight|route) connectivity, ferr(y|ies)
Distribution, OTAs & loyalty	online travel agen\w+, OTAs?, travel (agents?|advisors?|agencies), tour operators?, distribution, direct bookings?, booking (engines?|platforms?|channels?), GDS, global distribution systems?, NDC, metasearch, channel manag\w+, commission (fees?|rates?|levels|costs), loyalty (programs? |programmes?|members)
Events, MICE & business travel	business travel(lers?)?, corporate travel, MICE, business events?, meetings (industry|and events), conventions? (cent(re|er)s?|bureaus?), exhibitions?, incentive travel, event (industry|planners?|venues?), bleisure, conferences? and events
Costs, inflation & affordability	inflation, (rising|higher|operating|labou?r|energy|fuel|living) costs?, cost of living, affordab\w+, interest rates?, recession, economic (uncertainty|slowdown|downturn|headwinds), exchange rates?, tariffs?, price (increases?|rises?|hikes?), higher prices

Appendix B. Topics found without a dictionary (TF-IDF + NMF)

#	Most characteristic words	Articles	Main websites	Closest dictionary theme	% of topic articles discussing it
1	thailand, bangkok, event, tat, thai, marketing, macao, tour, china, destination, bangkok airways, director	425	PATA (407); UN Tourism (8); Travel Weekly (4)	Marketing & destination promotion	29.4
2	time, want, booking, make, don, guests, guest, need, customer, know, way, people	1293	Hospitality Net (886); Travel Weekly (237); PATA (137)	Guest experience & wellness	25.8
3	gdp, jobs, economy, contribution, spending, reach, visitor, visitor spending, international visitor, economic impact, economic, employment	224	WTTC (197); Hospitality Net (16); AHLA (5)	Travel demand & economic performance	95.1
4	congress, statement, act, washington, employees, workers, legislation, tax, rogers, small, small business, chip	331	AHLA (279); Travel Weekly (35); Hospitality Net (17)	Policy, regulation & visas	56.2
5	test, health, covid, vaccinated, negative, protocols, arrival, required, pcr, visitors, fully vaccinated, entry	235	CTO (166); PATA (24); Travel Weekly (18)	COVID-19 pandemic	80.4
6	resort, guests, resorts, property, luxury, rooms, suites, properties, located, dining, bar, spa	802	Hospitality Net (348); Travel Weekly (221); PATA (201)	Guest experience & wellness	36.7
7	hospitality, foundation, career, ahlef, training, trafficking, employees, washington, programs, state, human trafficking, careers	265	AHLA (158); Hospitality Net (48); PATA (29)	Workforce, skills & education	71.7
8	airlines, airline, flights, carrier, delta, flight, aircraft, routes, service, seats, flying, airport	522	Travel Weekly (399); PATA (72); CTO (44)	Air, cruise & connectivity	85.4
9	pololikashvili, secretary-general, zurab, zurab pololikashvili, secretary-general zurab, africa, development, innovation, rural, education, member states, minister	451	UN Tourism (430); Hospitality Net (10); PATA (9)	Sustainability & climate	36.6
10	occupancy, revpar, adr, str, performance, average daily, daily rate, revenue available, rate adr, available room, room revpar, rate	189	Hospitality Net (167); Travel Weekly (17); PATA (3)	Travel demand & economic performance	91.0
11	technology, sabre, solutions, platform, distribution, management, hospitality, software, leading, services, guest, solution	713	Hospitality Net (323); PATA (285); Travel Weekly (54)	Digital technology & data	33.2
12	climate, sustainability, sustainable, action, emissions, waste, environmental, change, climate change, green, carbon, climate action	543	PATA (240); UN Tourism (86); WTTC (71)	Sustainability & climate	89.7
13	university, shtm, school, hong kong, kong, hong, school management, polyu, researchers, kong polytechnic, polytechnic university, polytechnic	245	PATA (204); Hospitality Net (22); UN Tourism (13)	Workforce, skills & education	54.7
14	summit, global summit, global, leaders, growth, future, gloria, leadership, guevara, gloria guevara, private, event	520	WTTC (196); PATA (168); Hospitality Net (74)	Sustainability & climate	26.7
15	awards, cultural, heritage, winners, award, sustainable cultural, cultural heritage, best, sustainable, destinations, prize, destination	332	PATA (108); UN Tourism (99); CTO (52)	Culture, heritage & gastronomy	43.1
16	iata, air, air transport, aviation, transport, airlines, international air, traffic, passenger, juniac, transport iata, load factor	198	PATA (163); Travel Weekly (18); UN Tourism (9)	Air, cruise & connectivity	93.4

#	Most characteristic words	Articles	Main websites	Closest dictionary theme	% of topic articles discussing it
17	covid, health, safe, recovery, restrictions, measures, jobs, protocols, pandemic, travellers, safe travels, hygiene	408	WTTC (210); UN Tourism (81); PATA (37)	COVID-19 pandemic	85.5
18	barbados, islands, cayman, cayman islands, region, bryan, minister, antigua, marketing, onecaribbean, lucia, barbuda	279	CTO (253); PATA (17); UN Tourism (6)	Air, cruise & connectivity	18.6
19	europe, arrivals, destinations, compared, demand, travellers, respondents, markets, long-haul, months, summer, china	536	PATA (159); ETC (155); Hospitality Net (88)	Travel demand & economic performance	65.3
20	sustainable development, sustainable, development, international sustainable, rifai, international, taleb, taleb rifai, sdgs, development goals, secretary-general, secretary-general taleb	549	UN Tourism (444); PATA (77); ETC (10)	Sustainability & climate	54.3

Appendix C. Articles analysed by website and year

Website	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
UN Tourism	63	190	158	132	139	119	113	123	163	89	16
WTTC	5	18	15	60	114	134	83	68	67	77	92
IH&RA	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
PATA	55	219	218	129	227	381	182	208	204	278	243
AHLA	5	53	32	45	64	45	32	61	86	64	48
ETC	4	16	15	28	37	44	29	20	16	29	22
CTO	6	53	42	92	116	168	68	31	31	17	14
Hospitality Net	43	157	148	128	161	190	152	165	170	132	693
Travel Weekly	15	111	77	51	149	92	141	136	155	101	78

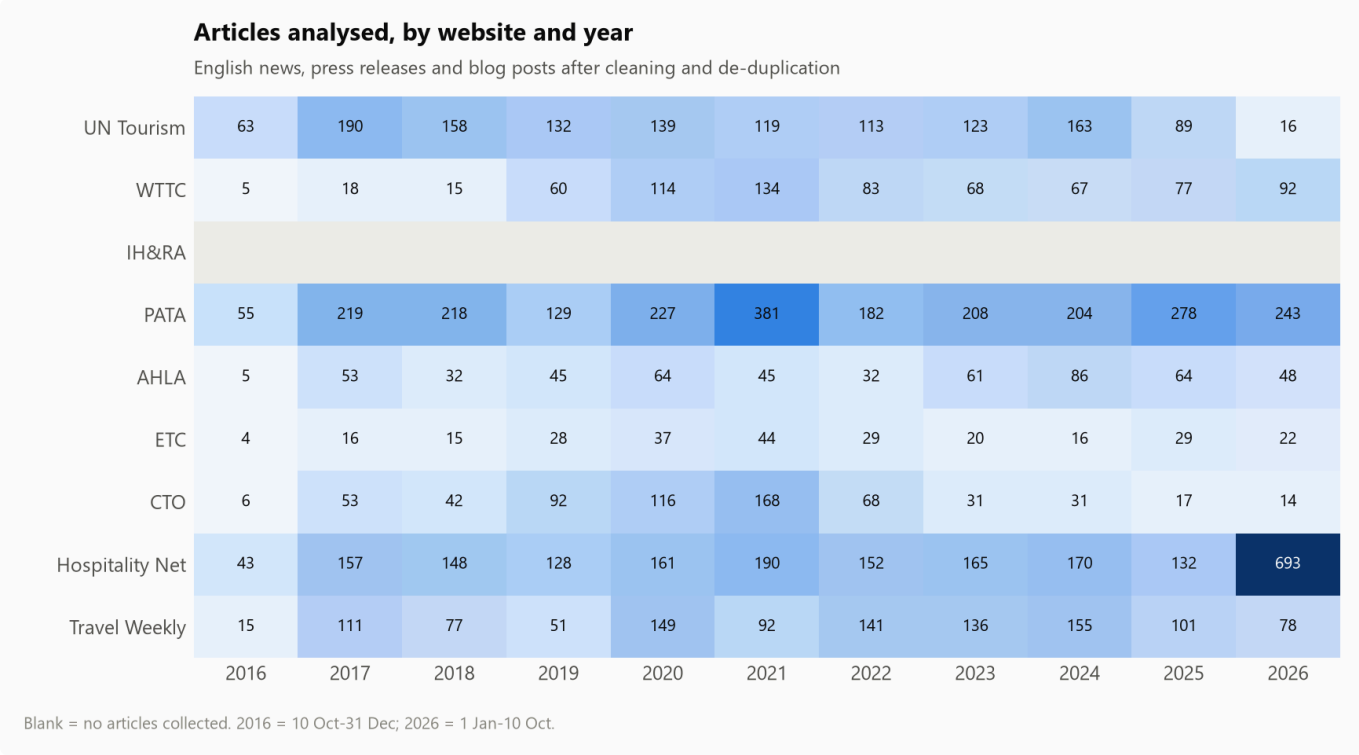


Figure 10. Articles analysed by website and year.

Appendix D. Files delivered

File	Contents
REPORT.pdf / REPORT.html	This report.
METHODOLOGY_SUMMARY.md	A one-paragraph methodology summary with the current numbers.
RESULTS.xlsx	All result tables, one sheet per table, with a README sheet.
tables/*.csv	The same tables as CSV, plus article-level data: `articles_analysed.csv` (metadata and URL of every article), `article_themes.csv` and `article_brands.csv` (every theme and brand coding with its sentiment score).
figures/*.png	All figures at print resolution.
codebook.json	The complete theme, brand and organisation dictionaries and coding rules.

Article texts are kept in the project database for re-analysis and are not redistributed, in line with the publishers' terms. The collection and analysis can be re-run with `python run_research.py`.